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We have gone from ‘why foldables’ to ‘which one’

Samsung’s Akshay Gupta on the Galaxy Z Fold 8 Series

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Samsung didn’t just launch one foldable this time. It launched three – the Galaxy Z Fold 8, the Fold 8 Ultra, and the Flip 8 – and sat across from a very different problem than the one it had a few years ago. Back then, the job was convincing people that foldables were worth buying at all. Now, with three devices on the table, the job is convincing people which one is actually worth buying.

Akshay Gupta, Director, MX Business, Samsung India, explains the genuinely strange new aspect ratio on the Fold 8, and how a category now in its eighth generation is still trying to shake off the word “niche.”

Why this specific aspect ratio, why now?

The most immediately noticeable thing about the new Fold 8 isn’t a spec sheet

number, it’s the shape. The aspect ratio is unlike anything else in the foldable space, and I wanted to know what actually drove that decision.

Gupta’s answer came down to a simple observation about how people actually consume content today. A consumer isn’t loyal to one format anymore, they’re watching reels on the go and OTT content at home, and neither fits comfortably on a standard smartphone screen. Reels get cropped or letterboxed. OTT content gets black bars. Nothing renders the way it was actually meant to be seen.

The Fold 8 tries to solve that with its own shapeshifting logic. The cover screen sits at 10:16, close enough to native reels and shorts formatting that there’s no cropping involved. Unfold it, and the aspect ratio becomes 4:3, closer to how long-form video is actually shot. Fold it into portrait, and it

lands at 3:4 – the ratio books and web pages are designed around, which means no more zooming in to tap a form field or hitting “request desktop site” out of frustration. It’s a small detail, but it’s the kind of detail that explains why Samsung didn’t just make a bigger foldable this time. It made a differently-shaped one.

Which foldable is for you

With three foldables on the table, the obvious risk is confusing the very consumer that Samsung is trying to win over. Gupta framed this as a good problem to have, but a real one nonetheless — and his answer was less about specs and more about identity. If productivity is the priority, the Fold 8 Ultra is the device.

If the priority is creating and consuming content, that’s the Fold 8. And if pocketability, flexibility, and camera angles no other phone can pull off matter more, that’s the Flip 8’s territory. The pitch, essentially, is that you don’t pick a foldable anymore. You pick a use case, and the foldable follows.

RAM-ageddon, pricing and not blaming the market

Given Samsung’s own position as a major memory manufacturer, I asked Gupta how the ongoing RAM and component price surge (what’s now being called RAM-ageddon) was shaping strategy. He sidestepped the framing almost entirely, calling pricing a derivative of proposition rather than the other way around.

His argument was that if the device genuinely delivers -- the brightest display yet, a reliable 5000mAh battery, a new titanium Flex hinge that makes the Fold 8 Ultra the lightest fold Samsung has built and consumers buy into that value regardless of whatever is happening upstream with AI and the consequent component costs. Whether that holds as component prices keep climbing is a separate conversation, but it’s a confident bet to make out loud. **d**